

Privacy by Choosing Less

Project: Helpful Classroom Sorter

1. Your mission

Your learning target

I can justify which information a stated task needs and remove unnecessary fields.

I can distinguish reducing personal data from hiding a name.

I can design a simple access, retention and deletion plan for a classroom activity.

Remember before reading

Close your notes first. A rough first answer helps us choose the right starting point; it is not a score for your ability.

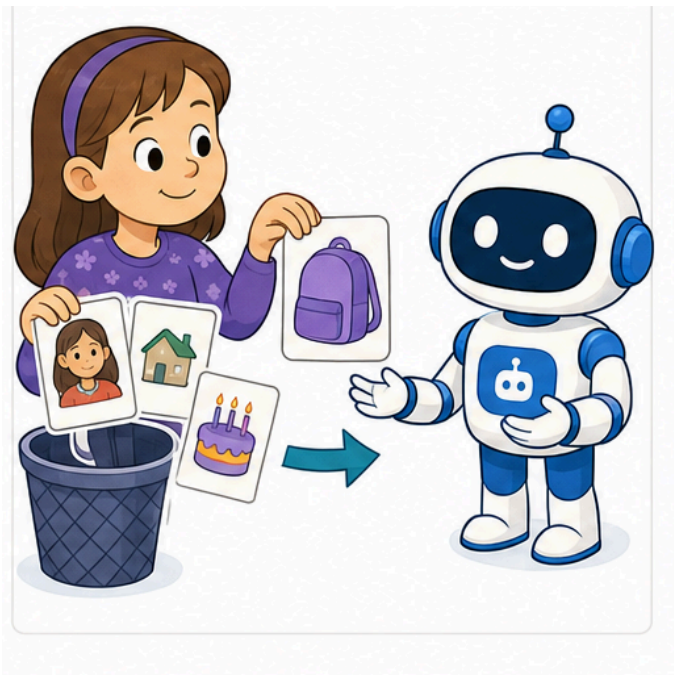
Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Fair for Whom?. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Good Data, Bad Data. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Confidence Is Not Correctness. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

After trying, check the relevant lesson or ask your teacher. Change the part of your explanation that the evidence shows was wrong.

A useful system should collect only information it truly needs.



LEARNING TARGET A book recommender requests genre, maximum pages, home address and a selfie. Keep only fields needed for genre and length matching. Explain one consequence of storing extra fields.

Learner name:

Readiness for the connected explanation

A report needs the number of correct answers out of 20 fictional test cards. Does that calculation require a student's name or home address? Explain.

This week's end goal

By the end, I can collect only information necessary for a stated task and explain coded-record limits.

2. Notice the evidence

PICTURE STORY

Look Closely Before You Explain

Pictures give clues; evidence tells us what the clues mean.



MYSTERY A lunch helper needs food preferences and allergy information for its task, not a face photo, home address, or family income.

What do you notice?

Name three visible details without explaining them yet.

Circle the detail most connected to the system's decision.

Name one detail that may be decoration or distraction.

Make a first prediction and state the clue that supports it.

My observations, prediction, and evidence:

GOOD THINKING A prediction can change when stronger evidence appears.

A closer explanation

Privacy includes having appropriate boundaries around information about people. A useful first question is: what exact job are we trying to do? A second is: what is the least information that can do that job? Collecting extra details just because a form has room for them creates more information to protect.

Our fictional class wants to choose one of three workshop topics for Friday: drawing, music or coding. It needs a total for each topic, not a list of who chose what. Each fictional pupil gets one paper slip and marks one topic. No real class survey is needed for this lesson. The teacher counts the choices and uses the largest total; a tie goes to a class discussion.

A proposed form asks for name, full date of birth, home address, photograph and topic choice. For the stated counting task only the topic choice is needed. Remove the other fields before collection. Do not fill

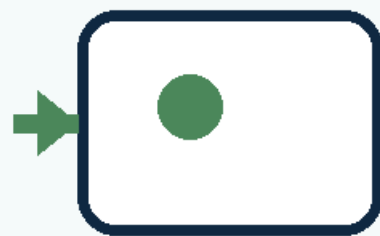
them in and promise to ignore them later. If the purpose changes to individual attendance, design and justify that separate task with the teacher rather than silently reusing the survey.

3. See how it works

VISUAL MECHANISM

Input → Process → Output

Follow the information instead of imagining magic inside the machine.



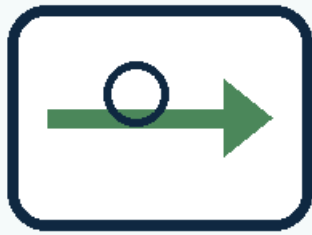
INPUT

candidate information fields



PROCESS

keep only fields needed for the stated goal



OUTPUT

useful result with reduced privacy risk

INPUT candidate information fields

PROCESS keep only fields needed for the stated goal

OUTPUT useful result with reduced privacy risk

CORE IDEA A useful system should collect only information it truly needs.

UNDER THE HOOD Data minimization limits collection, access, retention, and reuse to what is necessary for a defined purpose. Less data reduces breach exposure and misuse, but essential high-stakes information still needs secure, consent-aware handling.

Draw a fresh example with all three stages:

A closer explanation

A small information plan for a fictional vote

Stage · Needed action · Privacy check

Stage: Collect

Needed action: One topic per slip

Privacy check: No name or address

Stage: Count

Needed action: Teacher totals choices

Privacy check: Keep slips restricted

Stage: Share

Needed action: Three topic totals

Privacy check: No individual choices

Stage: Delete

Needed action: After totals checked

Privacy check: Follow agreed plan

Purpose: choose a workshop topic. Collect the minimum, limit access, share the required result and agree how long the source slips are kept.

Suppose the fictional counts are drawing 8, music 7 and coding 5. These totals support the choice of drawing. There is no need to publish each slip or a photograph of a child holding it. The teacher checks the total of 20 against the number of slips and then follows the agreed school process for disposing of the slips after verification.

A retention plan needs a clear trigger and a responsible person: for example, the teacher disposes of the fictional vote slips after the totals are checked and the activity closes. Real classroom records must follow the school's approved process. Deleting one visible copy does not prove that every backup, screenshot or previously shared copy is gone.

Connect the picture and the explanation

Point to the input, the deciding step and the result in this week's visual. Explain the same step in ordinary words. A picture helps when you can say what each part represents.

4. Compare the cases

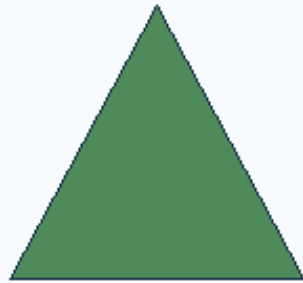
PICTURE GALLERY

Four Cases, Four Clues

Use the visual cue, then read the evidence carefully.



Allergy



Favorite foods



Home address



Face photo

CASE 1 — Allergy Clue: needed for safe lunch filter. Meaning: relevant sensitive data.

CASE 2 — Favorite foods Clue: useful for preference. Meaning: optional relevant data.

CASE 3 — Home address Clue: not needed. Meaning: remove.

CASE 4 — Face photo Clue: not needed for menu choice. Meaning: remove.

BOUNDARY Useful does not mean permitted forever or for every new purpose.

Which two pictures are easiest to confuse? What evidence separates them?

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: The teacher adds an authorised task to return one repaired tool to its borrower.

Prediction: A minimal contact mechanism may now be needed for that tool.

Reason: The purpose changed; reassess necessity rather than restoring every old field.

5. Words that unlock the idea

VOCABULARY

Words You Can See and Use

The badge is a memory cue; the definition does the real thinking work.





data minimization



purpose



Word · Meaning · My example

Word: privacy

Meaning: control and protection of information about people

My example: _____

Word: data minimization

Meaning: collecting only what the purpose requires

My example: _____

Word: purpose

Meaning: specific reason information is used

My example: _____

Word: retention

Meaning: how long information is kept

My example: _____

Misconception detective

CLAIM TO REPAIR Collect data now in case it becomes useful later.

Use one vocabulary word and one piece of evidence to repair it:

WORD POWER A strong definition helps you decide something in a new case.

Words used in the closer explanation

Word · Meaning

Word: Personal data

Meaning: Information about an identifiable person, including combinations that can identify someone

Word: Data minimisation

Meaning: Using only the information needed for a stated purpose

Word: Access control

Meaning: A rule and mechanism deciding who can see or use information

6. Follow a worked example

WORKED EXAMPLE

Watch the Reasoning, Not Just the Answer

Every step connects a claim to observable evidence.



CASE A lunch helper needs food preferences and allergy information for its task, not a face photo, home address, or family income.

STEP 1 — OBSERVE candidate information fields

STEP 2 — TRACE keep only fields needed for the stated goal

STEP 3 — CONCLUDE useful result with reduced privacy risk

MODEL REASONING Keep only information required for safety and stated preferences, allow a person to provide or update it, restrict access, and delete it when the purpose ends. Explain why each removed field adds risk without benefit.

DO NOT OVERCLAIM Useful does not mean permitted forever or for every new purpose.

What new evidence could change this answer?

A closer explanation

Proposed change · What it changes · What still needs thought

Proposed change: Replace a name with P07

What it changes: Hides the name on this sheet

What still needs thought: A separate key can reconnect the code

Proposed change: Remove names but keep photos

What it changes: Removes one identifying field

What still needs thought: Faces may still identify people

Proposed change: Share topic totals only

What it changes: Removes individual rows

What still needs thought: Small or unusual groups may still reveal a choice

A code is not a promise of anonymity. If a teacher keeps a key connecting P07 to a pupil, the coded record can still be linked to that pupil. Even without a key, a combination such as an exact birthday, a team and a photograph may identify someone. Ask whether a reader could connect the information to a person, not just whether the name column is blank.

Totals also need context. A report saying that the only member of a tiny club chose music reveals that member's choice. Our whole-class topic totals reveal less detail than individual rows, but we should not describe every possible total as automatically anonymous. Share only what the audience needs for the purpose.

Learn from the worked case

Cover the result before checking it. Say what is given, choose the procedure, and follow one step at a time. Then uncover the result and explain your first mismatch. Ask why a step is allowed, not only what number it produces.

A pictorial worked case: Privacy by Choosing Less

A fictional teacher wants to count broken craft tools by type, without contacting borrowers.

The facts we will use

Needed output: totals for scissors, ruler and hole-punch repairs.

Draft form requests pupil name, birthday, tool type and repair-needed Yes/No. No borrower follow-up is required.

Privacy by Choosing Less

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. State purpose

Count repairs by tool type, not by person.



2. Choose fields

Retain tool type and repair-needed status.



3. Remove excess

Name and birthday are unnecessary for this stated task.



4. Report totals

Aggregate each tool type's Yes count; record the authorised retention plan.

CHANGE ONE THING

The teacher adds an authorised task to return one repaired tool to its borrower.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. State purpose

What happens and why: Count repairs by tool type, not by person.

Step: 2. Choose fields

What happens and why: Retain tool type and repair-needed status.

Step: 3. Remove excess

What happens and why: Name and birthday are unnecessary for this stated task.

Step: 4. Report totals

What happens and why: Aggregate each tool type's Yes count; record the authorised retention plan.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

A field is justified by what the task needs to do, not by whether it might become useful someday. Names and birthdays do not help these repair totals. Replacing names with codes still leaves linked personal records if someone keeps a name-code key; collecting less can remove the need for that link entirely.

What this example does not establish

Removing these fields is not a universal guarantee of anonymity or permission to collect other identifying combinations.

7. Find and repair a mistake

COMPARE

Same Result, Different Reason

A comparison helps reveal the true concept boundary.

Case · Evidence · What it shows

Case: Allergy

Evidence: needed for safe lunch filter

What it shows: relevant sensitive data

Case: Favorite foods

Evidence: useful for preference

What it shows: optional relevant data

Case: Home address

Evidence: not needed

What it shows: remove

Case: Face photo

Evidence: not needed for menu choice

What it shows: remove

Repair two tempting claims

CLAIM A Collect data now in case it becomes useful later.

Repair:

CLAIM B Removing names makes all data anonymous and safe.

Repair:

STRONG ANSWER FRAME I claim _____ because the evidence shows _____. The process is _____. One limit is _____.

A closer explanation

A useful data plan answers five questions: what is the purpose; which fields are necessary; who needs access; what result will be shared; and when will the source information be disposed of under the agreed process? It also names who is responsible. “Keep everything safe forever” answers neither the collection question nor the retention question.

If you accidentally share personal information, stop sharing it and tell the teacher or another trusted adult promptly. Do not repost it to ask classmates for help. An adult can follow the school’s process and decide what action is appropriate. Avoid promising that deleting a message has removed every copy.

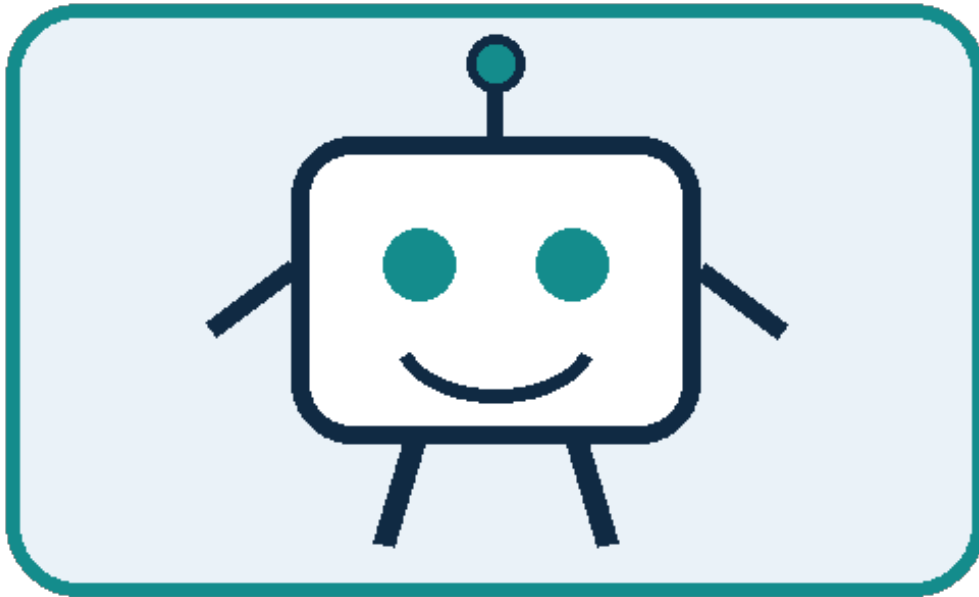
For the fictional workshop vote, name one field to collect and two to remove. State the audience for the totals and a clear trigger for the teacher to dispose of the slips under the agreed process

8. Practise together

GUIDED PRACTICE

Try It, Check It, Explain It

Use support now so you can succeed independently later.



Explain how the picture story demonstrates this idea: A useful system should collect only information it truly needs.

Use a fresh example to explain privacy.

Trace a new input → process → output example.

Find and repair the error in: Removing names makes all data anonymous and safe.

Invent one edge case and name the safe response.

PARTNER CHECK Point to the evidence. Do not accept an answer that only repeats the vocabulary word.

A closer explanation

An AI tool is another place where information may be sent. Before using it for schoolwork, follow the teacher's approved tool and data rules. Do not paste real names, contact details, photos, passwords or private messages into an unapproved service. For this lesson, use the provided fictional counts or work entirely on paper. An AI tool is not needed to add $8 + 7 + 5$.

A classmate proposes uploading the named vote spreadsheet to an AI tool to make a chart.

The required chart shows only three topic totals. Propose a smaller input, explain what must be checked before tool use, and name a way to complete the task without uploading data

A student may need the lesson and their own work; a teacher may need restricted teaching records. Access should match these jobs. A hidden link or a hard-to-guess filename is not a substitute for an access check. When information is shared more widely, it may be copied beyond the original audience. Decide the audience before sharing.

Practise with less help: Challenge a claim of anonymity

Use workbook W2 for the connected example “Privacy and data minimisation”. First fill the input and rule boxes. Try the middle steps before asking for a hint. After a hint, try the next step yourself.

Plan · Do · Check

Plan: What is given? Which rule or procedure applies?

Do: Record each intermediate step.

Check: Does the result follow? What remains unknown?

Explain your trace to a partner. Your partner points to one step to check. Swap roles on the next case. Each person writes their own explanation.

Check your reasoning

Use the worked case for Privacy and data minimisation. Proposed explanation: “More data always improves a task”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Answer on your own before discussion. If you are unsure, say which step you need help with.

Explain the picture

For the original task, does adding an anonymous-looking pupil code improve the repair count?

My explanation using a pictured step and the given facts

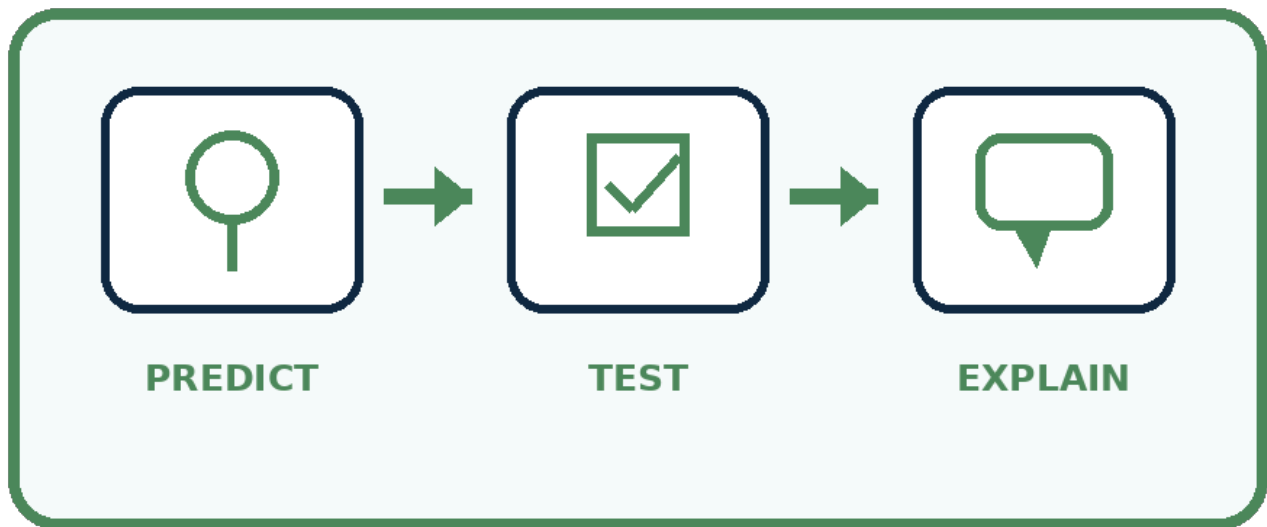
This is supported practice. Keep the separately named independent case for an attempt before feedback.

9. Run the investigation

EXPLORER LAB

Too-Much-Data Redesign

Predict first, test honestly, and explain what the evidence means.



State your prediction before the result is known.

Complete the task: Redesign a lunch helper that asks for too much personal data.

Keep a normal case and an edge case clearly separated.

Record what happened—even when it does not match your prediction.

Explain the result, one limitation, and the next useful test.

Case · Prediction · Observed result · What it means

Case: Normal

Prediction: _____

Observed result: _____

What it means: _____

Case: Edge

Prediction: _____

Observed result: _____

What it means: _____

INDEPENDENCE After support is removed, repeat the proof with a fresh case.

Plan → try → check

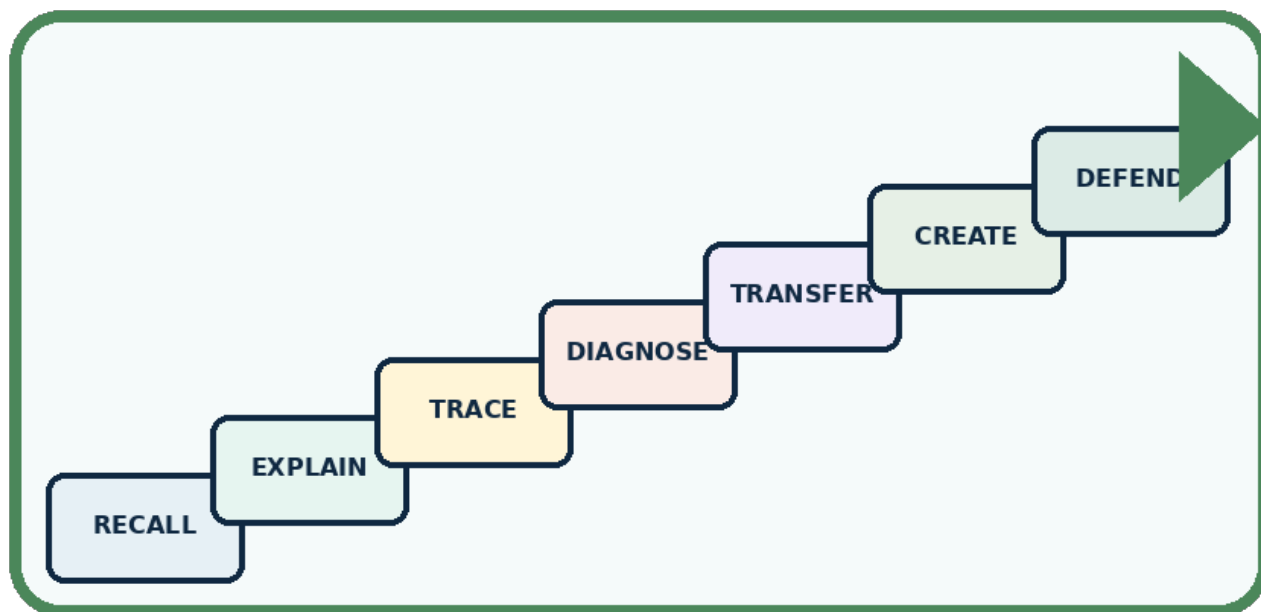
Before trying: what do I expect, and why? While trying: which step could first go wrong? Afterwards: what did I actually observe, and what should change? Keep “not run” if you only traced the procedure.

10. Build your understanding

PRACTICE LADDER

Climb from Recall to Defense

Each step asks for a stronger kind of understanding.



RECALL Define privacy.

EXPLAIN A useful system should collect only information it truly needs.

TRACE Show the input, process, and output.

DIAGNOSE Repair: Collect data now in case it becomes useful later.

TRANSFER Apply the idea to a new home or classroom case.

CREATE Design one revealing test.

DEFEND Give a claim, evidence, mechanism, limit, and safe action.

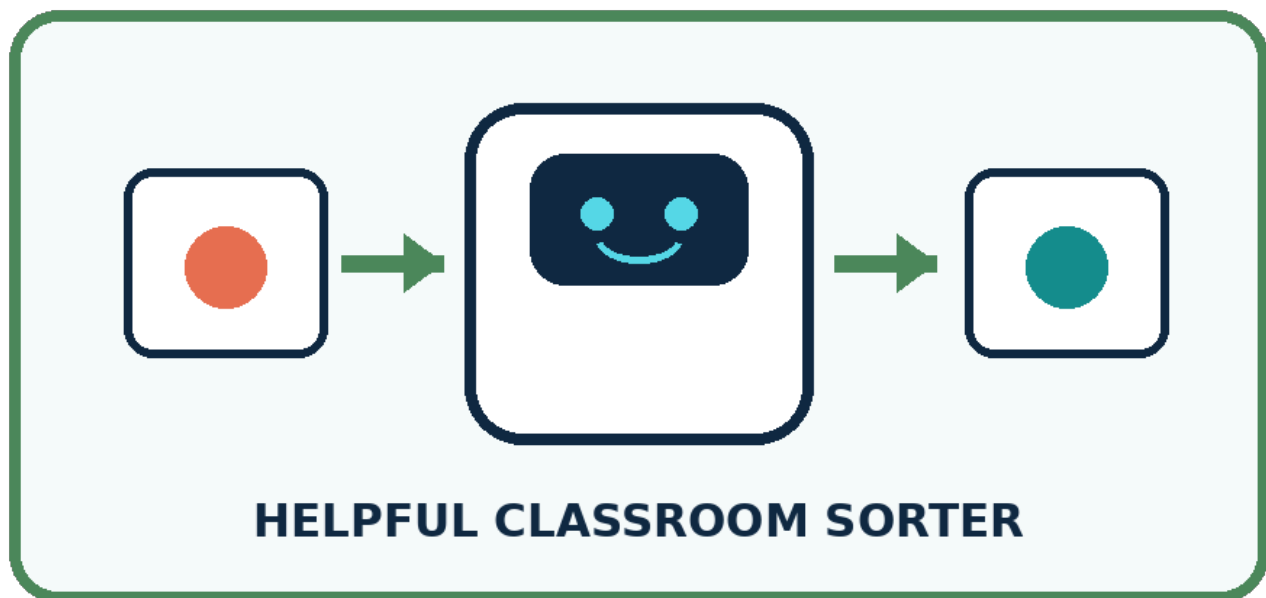
RETRY RULE A coached answer becomes mastery only after you solve a different case independently.

11. Connect your project

PROJECT

Helpful Classroom Sorter

Build one coherent system across the year, one evidence-based decision at a time.



THIS WEEK'S CHECKPOINT Cross out names, faces, and ownership details unless an explicit need survives review; set a deletion rule for sorter records.

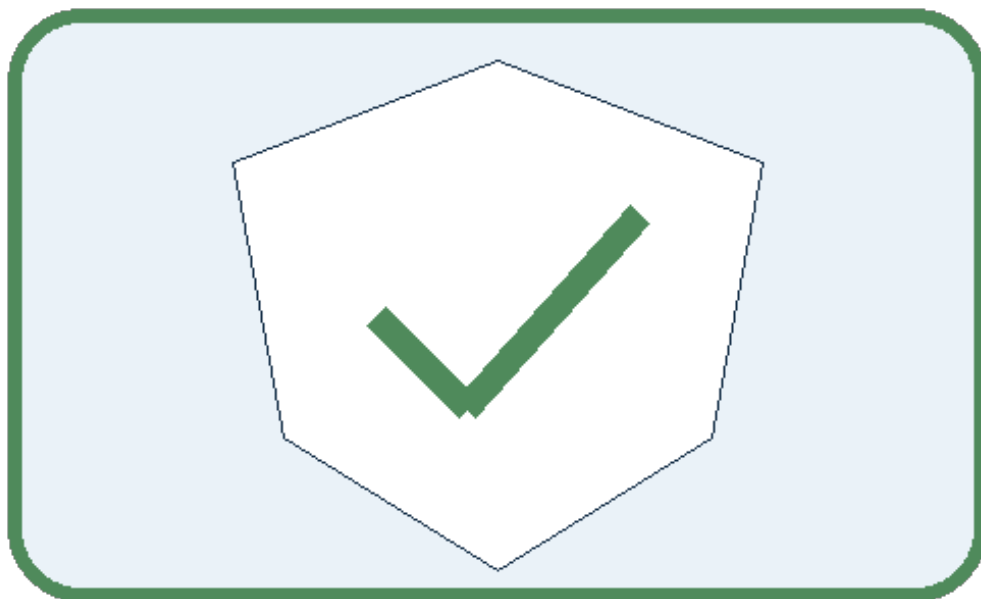
What real classroom need does this serve?

What information is necessary—and what should stay private?

What happens inside the process?

What normal and edge cases will you test?

When should it say not sure or ask a person?



RESPONSIBLE DESIGN Useful does not mean permitted forever or for every new purpose.

My project decision:

Evidence for your project

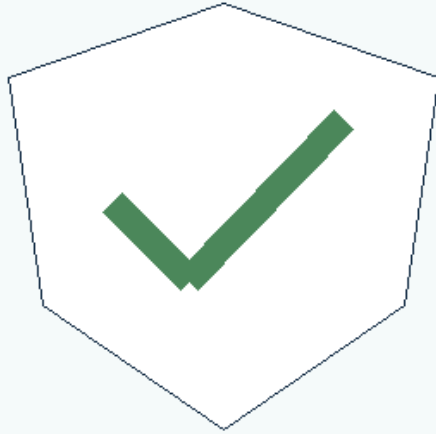
Write the sorter's purpose, necessary fields, access rules and deletion point before collecting any real classroom information.

12. Show what you know

MASTERY

Fresh-Case Independent Proof

Complete this after teaching and guided practice have ended.



INDEPENDENT PROOF

REQUIRED PROOF Remove unnecessary fields from a lunch helper and justify each remaining input, access rule, and deletion time.

- ☐ Name or draw the fresh case.
- ☐ Trace input, process, and output.
- ☐ State the conclusion and strongest evidence.
- ☐ Name one limit, failure, missing clue, or fairness/privacy concern.
- ☐ Explain one safe next action or improvement.

Independent evidence:

SELF-CHECK Keep only information required for safety and stated preferences, allow a person to provide or update it, restrict access, and delete it when the purpose ends. Explain why each removed field adds risk without benefit.

My level: ☐ Not yet ☐ With one hint ☐ Independently ☐ I can teach it

NEXT BRIDGE Carry today's evidence habit into: Generate, Retrieve, or Calculate?.

13. Study a complete case

Week 24 Worked case

Use the supplied details to practise the weekly concept before attempting the independent question. This

case extends the illustrated lesson.

The situation

A genre-based book helper asks for genre, home address and a photograph.

The question

Which fields are necessary?

Worked explanation

Genre is relevant; address and photo are unnecessary for the stated task. Collecting less reduces exposure.

Explain it in your own words

Which detail supports the answer, and why does it matter?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Trace the supplied case visually

Collect only what the book task needs

Evidence or stage · Value or result

Evidence or stage: Genre

Value or result: Useful for genre matching

Evidence or stage: Home address

Value or result: Not needed for this task

Evidence or stage: Photograph

Value or result: Not needed for this task

A genre-based book helper asks for genre, home address and a photograph.

Which fields are necessary?

Genre is relevant; address and photo are unnecessary for the stated task. Collecting less reduces exposure.

14. Try a new case independently

Independent case: Design a different minimal-data task

A fictional library wants only the total number of books needing repair in each category: cover, page or binding. It does not need to contact borrowers. A draft repair sheet asks for borrower name, home address, book repair category and borrower photograph. Design a plan: state the purpose, required and removed fields, who handles source sheets, what totals are shared with the librarian, and who disposes of sheets at what agreed point. Use no real borrower details.

My independent explanation, trace and limits

Attempt this case before feedback. Record any help. Earlier examples below are further practice; a case already practised with feedback cannot establish fresh transfer.

Week 24 Independent application

Close the worked explanation. Apply the idea to this different question without copying.

A book helper needs reading topic and approximate difficulty. Someone asks it to collect home address too. Which information can be left out, and why?

My answer, with a trace, calculation or supporting evidence

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Create and test

Change one relevant detail. Predict the result before testing. Include a boundary or missing-information case when it helps reveal a limit.

My changed input and expected result

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Connect to your project

Cross out names, faces, and ownership details unless an explicit need survives review; set a deletion rule for sorter records.

The evidence I will keep

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Your teacher has the independent answer and scoring criteria. Complete the matching workbook week to keep your practice evidence together.

Transfer practice from the original programme

A book recommender requests genre, maximum pages, home address and a selfie. Keep only fields needed for genre and length matching. Explain one consequence of storing extra fields.

Explain the mechanism, evidence and one limit.

Use feedback to improve

Attempt the independent case before hints. Record whether you worked alone, used a hint or followed a model. After feedback, fix the first unsupported step and explain why it changed. A later check uses a changed case, not a copied answer.